The Fury of Rain Storms – A Collection

by Anne Sexton, Sylvia Plath and Stephen King

The Fury of Rain Storms
by Anne Sexton

(Pg 372) The rain drums down like red ants,
each bouncing off my window.
The ants are in great pain
and they cry out as they hit
as if their little legs were only
stitched on and their heads pasted.
And oh they bring to mind the grave,
so humble, so willing to be beat upon
with its awful lettering and
the body lying underneath
without an umbrella.
Depression is boring, I think

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and I would do better to make
some soup and light up the cave.

SOURCE INFORMATION

Author: Anne Sexton
Book: The Complete Poems: Anne Sexton, Pg 372
ISBN: 978-0395957769
Publisher: Ecco
Date (Month/Year): April 1999

INTRODUCTION

According to Stephen King . . . " we're all mentally ill; those of us outside the asylums only hide it a little better."

Popular culture has long stereotyped poets as depressed and creative scientists as mad. In fact, the idea of a link between creativity and mental illness goes back to the time of Aristotle, when he wrote that eminent philosophers, politicians, poets and artists all have tendencies toward "melancholia."

Indeed, there are numerous examples of famous creators-- writers like Virginia Woolf, painters like Vincent Van Gogh, poets like Anne Sexton and Sylvia Plath -- who have been highly successful are suspected to have had some type of mental illness.

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Apprehensions by Sylvia Plath

There is this white wall, above which the sky creates itself---

Infinite, green, utterly untouchable.

Angels swim in it, and the stars, in indifference also.

They are my medium.

The sun dissolves on this wall, bleeding its lights.

A gray wall now, clawed and bloody.

Is there no way out of the mind?

Steps at my back spiral into a well.

There are no trees or birds in this world,

There is only sourness.

This red wall winces continually:

A red fist, opening and closing,

Two gray, papery bags---

This is what I am made of, this and a terror

Of being wheeled off under crosses and a rain of pietas.

On a black wall, unidentifiable birds

Swivel their heads and cry.

There is no talk of immortality among these!

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Cold blanks approach us:

They move in a hurry.

SOURCE INFORMATION

Author: Sylvia Plath
Book: Winter Trees, 1st poem in the collection
ISBN: 978-0571108626
Publisher: Faber and Faber
Date (Month/Year): Sept 1975

Paranoid: A Chant by Stephen King

(Pgs 274-277) I can't go out no more.

There's a man by the door

in a raincoat

smoking a cigarette.

But

I've put him in my diary

and the mailers are all lined up

on the bed, bloody in the glow

of the bar sign next door.

He knows that if I die

(or even drop out of sight)

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the diary goes and everyone knows
the CIA`s in Virginia.

500 mailers bought from
500 drug counters each one different
and 500 notebooks
with 500 pages in every one.

I am prepared

I can see him from up here.
His cigarette winks from just
above his trench coat collar
and somewhere there's a man on a subway
sitting under a Black Velvet ad thinking my name.

Men have discussed me in back rooms.
If the phone rings there's only dead breath.

In the bar across the street a snubnose
revolver has changed hands in the men's room.
Each bullet has my name on it.
My name is written in back files
and looked up in newspaper morgues.

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My mother's been investigated;
thank God she's dead.

They have writing samples
and examine the back loops of pees
and the crosses of tees.

My brother's with them, did I tell you?
His wife is Russian and he
keeps asking me to fill out forms.
I have it in my diary.
Listen--
listen
do listen:
you must listen.

In the rain, at the bus stop,
black crows with black umbrellas
pretend to look at their watches, but
it's not raining. Their eyes are silver dollars.
Some are scholars in the pay of the FBI
most are the foreigners who pour through
our streets. I fooled them

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got off the bus at 25th and Lex
where a cabby watched me over his newspaper.

In the room above me an old woman
has put an electric suction cup on her floor.
It sends out rays through my light fixture
and now I write in the dark
by the bar signs glow.

I tell you I know.

They sent me a dog with brown spots
and a radio cobweb in its nose.
I drowned it in the sink and wrote it up
in folder GAMMA.

I don't look in the mailbox anymore.
The greeting cards are letter-bombs.

(Step away! Goddamn you!
Step away, I know tall people!
I tell you I know very tall people!)

The luncheonette is laid with talking floors
and the waitress says it was salt, but I know arsenic

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when it's put before me. And the yellow taste of mustard
to mask the bitter odor of almonds.

I have seen strange lights in the sky.
Last night a dark man with no face crawled through nine
miles
of sewer to surface in my toilet, listening
for phone calls through the cheap wood with
chrome ears.
I tell you man, I hear.

I saw his muddy handprints
on the porcelain.

I don't answer the phone now,
have I told you that?

They are planning to flood the earth with sludge.
They are planning break-ins.

They have got physicians
advocating weird sex positions.
They are making addictive laxatives
and suppositories that burn.

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They know how to put out the sun

with blowguns.

I pack myself in ice - have I told you that?

It obviates their infrascopes.

I know chants and I wear charms.

You may think you have me but I could destroy you

any second now.

Any second now.

Any second now.

Would you like some coffee, my love?

Did I tell you I can't go out no more?

There's a man by the door

in a raincoat.

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SOURCE INFORMATION

Author: Stephen King
Book: Skeleton Crew, Pgs 274-277
ISBN: 978-0451142931
Publisher: Signet Books
Date (Month/Year): June 1986

AWARD HISTORY

2004 National Qualifier (Apprehensions and Paranoid)
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